The Payson Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Morndas, the 26th of Frostfall (Monday, October 26, 2026) ·
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Gandy dozes through the grey morning while Maevy stalks one brave leaf.

Skies o'er the Hold

68° / 44°

Overcast

Sunrise 6:40 AM · Sunset 5:37 PM

Tomorrow — Overcast, 70/48

The Moon's Reckoning



Yesterday · *Tonight — Full Moon* · *Tomorrow*

waning toward the new moon

26th of Frostfall = October 26

Months run one-for-one all year
Sundas=Sun … Loredas=Sat

Morning	Noon	Late Afternoon	Evening
55°	66°	64°	54°
Sunny	Sunny	Overcast	Overcast
			
4 mph	5 mph	4 mph	5 mph

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Halloween Week Opens With Music, Pumpkins, and Grey Skies



Payson, Ariz.



A bard tunes up in a timber village square as Halloween week opens across the Holds.

PAYSON — Hail, wayfarer, and good Morndas to you! Grey clouds ride over the Rim this morning, yet the Holds are merry: bards tune up in Pine tonight, the library in Payson keeps its doors wide, story time rings out in Show Low, and Sedona hangs fresh paintings still smelling of pine air. All week the road runs toward Halloween — trail work, murals, gravel racers, and a lantern-lit fort await. Draw up a chair, pour something warm, and plan your week by the Nine.

Happening in the Holds Today

- **Payson**

  — **Payson Public Library — Tai Chi and Sit & Stitch** — The library at 328 N. McLane Road opens the week in its usual kindly way, with Tai Chi in the morning and the Sit & Stitch circle later in the day. Bring a project, borrow a book, or simply sit a spell among neighbors. It is the quiet, friendly start to a busy Halloween week, and the staff are glad to point guests toward more doings about town. To register for library events, call 928-474-9260.

- **Pine-Strawberry**

  — **Open Mic Night: Music with a Purpose — THAT Brewery & Pub, Pine** — Tonight from 4 o’clock at 3270 N. Highway 87, the microphones open and the whole village is the band. Rotating members of the Pine Strawberry Fuel Reduction team host the evening, and tips go to their work keeping the forest safer for everyone. Sing a song, tell a tale, or just cheer the brave — a mead-hall night in the pines, with a good cause in every cup.

- **Sedona**

  — **Sedona Plein Air Exhibition Opens** — Fresh from the festival fields, the paintings made outdoors among the red rocks go on show today, running through November 22. Artists spent the festival chasing desert light, and now guests can walk the walls at leisure and see the canyons as a painter’s eye caught them. A fine, unhurried stop paired with a stroll through Sedona’s galleries and courtyards.

- **Show Low**

  — **Story Time — Show Low Public Library** — Mondays at 10:00 to 10:30 in the morning, the Kids Room fills with picture books, songs, and small happy chaos. The free drop-in session is made for ages 0 to 5 and builds the first steps toward reading, one story at a time. No sign-up is needed — just bring your smallest traveler. For word, call the library at 928-532-4070.

The Days Ahead

- **Tue, Oct. 27**

  — **Trail Day Volunteer Build — Pine** — From 7 in the morning to noon off Highway 87 in Pine, volunteers clear brush, move rocks, and shape a trail built to serve the Hold for years. The work also opens better access for firefighters, so every armful of brush does double duty. Tools are provided; bring water, sunscreen, gloves, and sturdy shoes. To volunteer, write to trails@psfuelreduction.org for directions.

- **Thu, Oct. 29**

  — **Halloween Spooktacular Carnival — Show Low Public Library** — The library turns carnival at 3 o’clock, with games, activities, treats for everyone, and a costume contest at 4 o’clock with fun prizes. Ghosts, goblins, and one very serious small dragon or two are all welcome. It is free family fun in the heart of Show Low, and a fine warm-up for the big night itself.

  — **Marigold Mural Project Begins — Tlaquepaque, Sedona** — From today through November 1, visitors are invited to paint a tribute to a loved one on the community remembrance wall at Tlaquepaque Arts & Shopping Village. The mural grows flower by flower all week, bright marigolds against the courtyards and sycamores. Come add a name, a color, and a memory — the village supplies the wall, you supply the heart.

- **Fri, Oct. 30**

  — **Prescott — The Rough Rider Gravel Race Begins** — Three days of wild riding open today at Prescott Courthouse Square, 120 South Cortez Street, and run through Sunday, November 1. This bold new three-stage gravel race sends riders out over high-desert roads and brings them home to historic downtown each day. Not riding? The square itself is the show — cheer the starts, watch the finishes, and enjoy Prescott at its autumn best.

- **Sat, Oct. 31**

  — **A Haunting at the Fort — Fort Verde State Historic Park, Camp Verde** — From 6 to 8 in the evening at 125 E. Hollamon Street, the old fort opens after hours for a ghostly lantern-lit walk. Hear the ghost stories, wander the parade ground by lantern glow, and visit with those who, the rangers say, still call the fort home after 150 years. Spooky, merry, and made for Halloween night itself.

— **Uptown Trick or Treat — Sedona** — From 5 to 8 in the evening along Uptown Sedona, 200 N. State Route 89A, the shops open their doors to costumed travelers great and small. Bring a bag, mind the ghouls, and gather sweets beneath the red rocks as the light fades. A beloved Sedona Halloween custom, right in the heart of town.

— **Morning Café — Unity of Payson** — Start Halloween morning gently at 9:30, in person at 110 E. Bonita Street in Payson or by Zoom from your own fireside. Morning Café is an inspirational hour of talk and good company to open the day. Costumes are not required — but by the Nine, nobody will stop you.

- **Sun, Nov. 1**

  — **Día de los Muertos — Tlaquepaque, Sedona** — Sedona closes the week in remembrance and celebration, with altars, music, and cultural performances honoring loved ones who have died. The Marigold Mural, painted by visitors all week, stands at the heart of it. Go gently, go gladly — this is one of the most beautiful days of the Sedona year.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:



The shield takes its place by the door while the torch sconces wait their turn on the bench.

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Measure the flame bulb and socket, then scale the sconce model to fit.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Print two torches plus the socket test piece and test-fit before finishing.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Paint, UV-seal, and wire the sockets with the breaker off.
- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Cut and engrave the shield, sized for its place by the door.
- ☐ **Mount the shield by the front door** — Hang it on a French cleat beside the front door, facing the walkway.
- ☐ **Doors — Mogollon Hearth** — Front and side door work for the guest house.

Longest waiting: the torch sconces, first due September 26 — the Hearth's torches have waited a full month for their flame.

Merchant of the Hold

Persnikkity's Cafe · *Show Low*



Persnikkity's, as the bards picture it: an alchemist's espresso bench and a counter of wonders.

An eclectic cafe-bakery with a full espresso bar, fruit smoothies, baked-from-scratch sweet treats, sandwiches, wraps, bountiful salads, and stacked-up burgers — as if a kindly alchemist had enchanted a diner. The signature bite is the Famous Brown Sugar French Toast, made with thick-cut brioche; regulars also swear by the Cowboy Burger and the Banana Pecan Waffles.

> *"Coffee and pastries, sandwiches for lunch, yummy sides - and TWO locations, the second featuring even more desserts. The cupcakes are beyond epic. 100% recommend!"* — Google review

161 E. Deuce of Clubs, Show Low. Open Monday–Thursday 9 AM–3 PM and Friday–Saturday 9 AM–8 PM (closed Sundays). Phone (928) 251-1965. Moderate prices. Good to know: the cupcakes and baked treats go fast — arrive before the lunch crowd if your heart is set on one. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you: Great Praise is Great! The Hearth sends guests east to Persnikkity's when the road calls for French toast worth crossing a Hold for — Valley Dwellers trading lowland heat for White Mountain air will find it a merry stop.

Tales from the Treeline

The Pumpkin Boat Parade



Henny launches the pumpkin boat while Mabel conducts and Flurry frosts the prow.

Morndas dawned grey over the Hearth, and Mabel (a wood elf) declared the clearing wanted a pumpkin garland before Halloween. She strung the little pumpkins stem to stem along the porch rail while Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) breathed a careful frost on every stem to keep the whole chain stiff and straight. It was, for nearly a minute, the finest garland in the Hold.

Then Henny (the Hearth's plump chicken) found the one hollow pumpkin Mabel had set aside for a lantern. Henny climbed in, settled herself like a jarl launching a longship, and refused every order to disembark. Flurry, delighted, frosted a tiny prow. Mabel sighed her longest sigh, tied the garland's end to the pumpkin, and led the slowest parade in Rim Country history twice around the clearing — one frosted dragon marching, one elf conducting, and Henny, unbothered and magnificent, sailing six inches above the pine needles in her pumpkin boat.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Morndas be free of trolls, the admin.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com